

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal research, document review, case file management and drafting across disputes, regulatory and data-privacy matters at BCLP, Q-Legal and Citizens Advice. Experienced in conducting cross-jurisdictional legal research, maintaining structured electronic matter records, and communicating legal analysis clearly to clients and colleagues. Developing a focused interest in financial markets and regulatory frameworks, with a foundation in cross-border legal analysis from an LLM dissertation awarded Distinction.

EDUCATION

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| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law and evidence analysis, with a focus on cross-jurisdictional legal frameworks• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75% | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules included Commercial Law, Advanced Contract Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution | |
| International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

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| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Aug 2023 – Feb 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Conducted legal research and drafted procedural orders, procedural histories and sections of the Claimant's memorial for a complex investment arbitration• Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines• Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time submission• Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external Romanian translations• Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes• Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials• Maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines• Assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and cost comparisons | |
| Q-Legal · London
Legal Adviser | Oct 2024 – Jan 2025 |

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, for a data-driven start-up
- Identified legal and compliance risks from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across employment, housing, welfare and debt matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex points and translates requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed data-processing provisions and researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; cross-jurisdictional legal analysis; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured electronic case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multi-matter workloads